



RESURRECTED PLANS
An image from the Amaravati masterplan designed by Foster+ Partners in 2018; (inset) Naidu at the CRDA building project work inauguration, Oct. 19

ATI RISES AGAIN

(CRDA) office on October 19. The building, at Rayapudi in Amaravati, is more than 70 per cent complete but, again, no work happened on it in the last five years during the Yuvajana Sramika Rythu Congress Party (YSRCP) government.

Work on the major projects in the proposed city will start by January 2025. To ensure there are no hiccups, a separate environment and social impact unit is being set up at the CRDA for environmental clearances. "Fast-track clearances are essential. Projects worth an estimated Rs 50,000 crore are happening, which will require individual clearances from the Union environment ministry and the state agency. A dedicated unit at CRDA will help avoid delays," says P. Narayana, the municipal administration minister.

Funding is no longer a challenge. The state is expecting the World Bank and the Asian Development Bank (ADB) to clear the loans shortly. All old tenders are being shelved and estimates are being prepared for completing development works in two phases within 24 months. Iconic buildings are expected to take a tad longer (30 months) with the designs approved earlier for the new high court and legislature buildings being used with no changes.

Naidu wants to make sure that large parts of Amaravati are up and running before the 2029 assembly election. To assuage the expectations raised by Jagan's now aborted 'three capitals' plan, Naidu has announced that the port city of Visakhapatnam will be developed as the financial capital while a high court bench and industries will be set up at Kurnool. Jagan had proposed to make Visakhapatnam the administrative capital, Amaravati the legislative capital and move the judiciary to Kurnool on the plea of promoting equitable development of all the regions. But, as often happens in the state, news of dubious deals in Vizag's real estate market had cast a cloud on that narrative.

Naidu referenced those reported

CAPITAL TIES

- **World Bank and ADB commit $1,600 million (Rs 13,600 cr.) funds for first phase of Amaravati**
- **All old tenders shelved, fresh estimates to favour project completion in 2 years**
- **Jagan's three-capital plan shelved, Vizag to be financial capital, Kurnool to get HC bench**